ART

Reaching for the Moon

Artist **Lekha Washington's** newest installation helps bring the moon down to Bandra

For passersby on Mumbai's Carter Road crossing, the moon has perhaps never seemed closer. Now only 70 feet above their heads, 'Chand' sits on a small iron platform. Conceptualised by designer and installation artist Lekha Washington, the 12-foot-wide steel orb is already turning heads.

Commissioned four years ago, as part of the Mumbai Street Art project by the RPG group, 'Chand' or 'Moonrock' has been created by joining blocks of textured steel surfaces, coated with different paints to mimic 'moon craters' and the orb is lit by a set of spotlights. The rear side of the moon has



CELESTIAL ART
Lekha Washington poses with her moon drop chair; and her 'Moonrock' installation

Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**

ART

MAKING GOLD WITH BRONZE

Released in the year of his birth centenary, a new book hopes to give sculptor **Amar Nath Sehgal** the mainstream recognition he was denied in his lifetime

Born in 1922, Amar Nath Sehgal had witnessed the horrors of Partition first hand. Though he left for New York shortly post Independence, the tragedies of his youth continued to haunt him. It took a chance meeting with Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru in 1956 for him to want to return home. A gifted sculptor, the story of Sehgal's life was as extraordinary as it was untold. Recently, on his 100th birth anniversary, his son Rajan Sehgal teamed up with his elder brother Raman to launch a book shoring up his father's artistic legacy.

Based in New Delhi, the Sehgal family had in 2019 converted the artist's former studio in Jangpura to a private collection. Drawing from family lore, historical archives, handwritten books of poetry, articles in the media and well-preserved correspondence between Sehgal and his family and friends, the 248 pages of *100 Years of Sehgal* contain hundreds of photographs of his sculptures, paintings and some essays.

"My father was basically a *kabadiwala* (scrap dealer)—and thank god for that," says Rajan, with a laugh. "His studio was full of boxes, papers, sketches and documents. He didn't throw away a single scrap of paper in his life."

Mandira Row, the Amar Nath Sehgal Private Collection's resident curator, suggests that the sculptor, who died at the age of 85 in 2007, was not fully understood in his own lifetime. She

